

## EXPERIMENT 5

### Dashboard Creation in Zoho Creator

#### 1. Aim

To design and implement a Dashboard in Zoho Creator for visualizing and managing restaurant order data using various widgets, charts, and reports, and to understand the process of building an interactive dashboard for a business application.

#### 2. Introduction

A Dashboard in Zoho Creator is a visual interface that provides a consolidated view of key metrics and data points from an application. It allows users to monitor important information at a glance using widgets, charts, graphs, and quick links. Dashboards help in decision-making by presenting real-time data in an organized and visually appealing manner. Zoho Creator provides drag-and-drop dashboard components that can be configured to display data from various forms and reports.

#### 3. Objectives of the Study

- To understand the concept and purpose of dashboards in Zoho Creator.
- To learn how to create and configure a dashboard using different widgets.
- To understand how to add charts, summary cards, and quick links to a dashboard.
- To explore the customization of dashboard layout and components.
- To develop a functional dashboard for a real-world restaurant management use case.

#### 4. Procedure

- Log in to the Zoho Creator platform.
- Open the existing application or create a new application for the required use case.
- Navigate to the Dashboard section and create a new dashboard.
- Add summary widgets to display key metrics such as total orders, total sales, pending orders, and completed orders.
- Configure the widgets with appropriate data sources and aggregation functions.
- Add chart widgets such as bar charts, pie charts, and line charts to visualize order and sales trends.
- Add quick links to forms for easy order entry and navigation.
- Arrange and customize the dashboard layout for better visual presentation.
- Save and preview the dashboard to verify its appearance and functionality.
- Publish the application after completing the dashboard creation.

## 5. Illustrative Example

Consider a Restaurant Order Management System in which customer orders, menu items, sales information and order status are managed through a Zoho Creator application.

### 5.1 Implementation using Zoho Creator

Create a Dashboard for the Restaurant Order Management System. Add summary widgets such as Total Orders, Total Sales, Pending Orders, and Completed Orders. Add an Order Status section displaying counts for New, Preparing, Ready, and Delivered orders. Add Quick Links for creating a New Order, adding a Menu Item, viewing Orders, and opening the Customer List. Add a chart such as Sales by Category to visualize the distribution of sales across menu categories. Store and display all data in real time. Generate reports to view and manage order, menu, customer and sales information.

### 5.2 Illustrative Dashboard Design

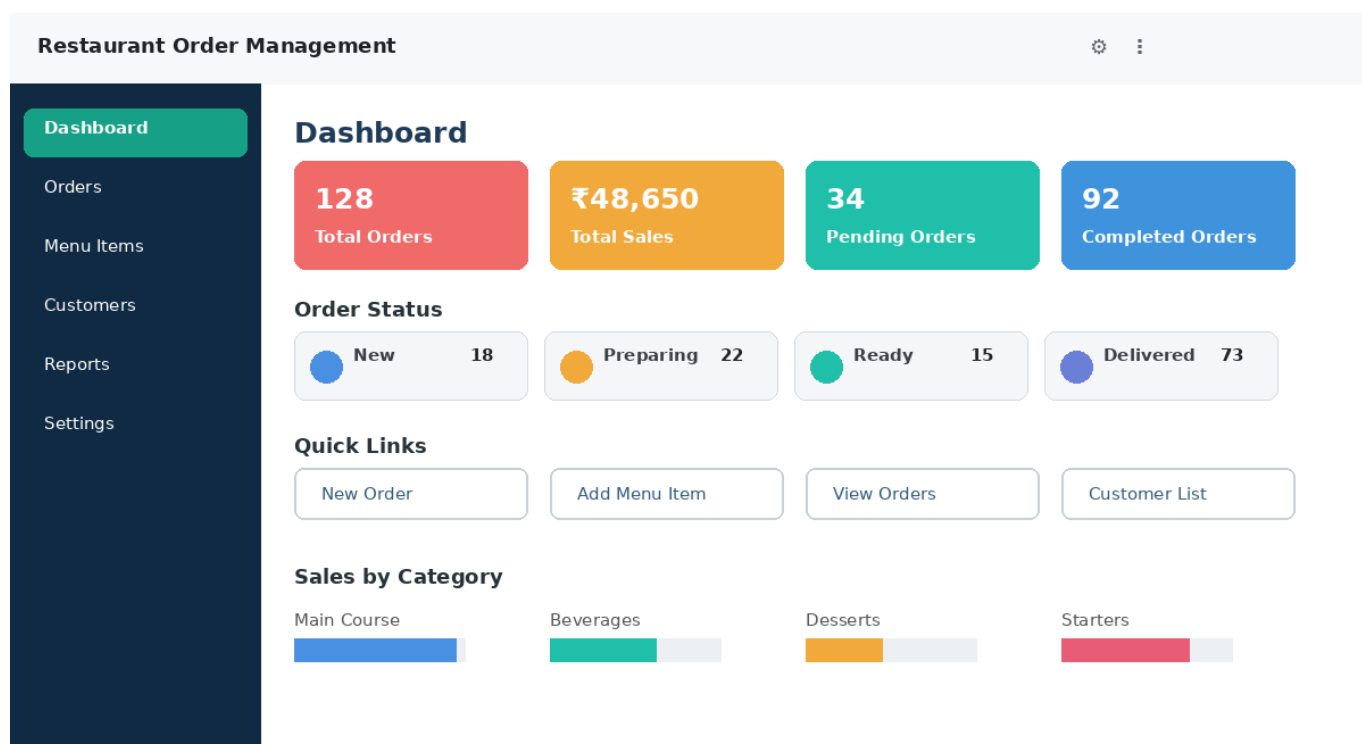


Figure 1: Restaurant Order Management Dashboard in Zoho Creator.

## 6. Dashboard Components

- Summary Widgets – Display Total Orders, Total Sales, Pending Orders and Completed Orders.
- Order Status – Shows the current distribution of New, Preparing, Ready and Delivered orders.
- Quick Links – Provide direct access to New Order, Menu Items, Orders and Customer records.
- Sales Chart – Visualizes sales distribution across menu categories.
- Reports – Provide detailed views of order and sales records.

## 7. Advantages and Limitations

### 7.1 Advantages

- Provides a consolidated view of important restaurant metrics.
- Visual representation of order and sales data improves understanding.
- Real-time data updates help monitor restaurant performance.
- Quick links enable easy navigation and data entry.
- Dashboards can be customized with drag-and-drop components.
- Reduces the need for manual report generation.

### 7.2 Limitations

- Complex dashboard customization may require Deluge scripting.
- Performance may be affected with large datasets.
- Advanced chart types may require additional configuration.
- Dashboards depend on the capabilities of the selected platform.
- Large or highly specialized enterprise systems may need additional development.

## 8. Result

The experiment was completed successfully by studying dashboard creation and implementing an interactive dashboard for the Restaurant Order Management System in Zoho Creator. The exercise demonstrated how summary widgets, charts, quick links, and navigation components can be combined to create a comprehensive business dashboard with reduced coding effort.